Semiclassical scattering of Boussinesq solitons: symplectic structure, topological phases and integrable defects

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Sections 7–9 are placeholders; Section 10 will be revised.

Abstract

We study the two-body scattering of solitons of the Boussinesq equation at the semiclassical level. The main thread is the well-posed ("good") equation $u_{tt} = u_{xx} - u_{xxxx} - 3(u^2)_{xx}$; the ill-posed ("bad") equation $v_{tt} = v_{xx} + v_{xxxx} + 3(v^2)_{xx}$ is treated in parallel through an explicit dictionary. Unlike sine-Gordon or affine Toda solitons, Boussinesq solitons have no boost symmetry, move through a gapless phonon background, and carry a continuous topological charge $M = \int u\,dx$. We show that two-soliton scattering is an exactly symplectic map of the canonical phase space, provided one includes ordering-dependent cross terms $d\Pi_i \wedge dM_j$ between the shift charge of one soliton and the topological charge of another. Darboux coordinates then give a closed-form semiclassical phase,

$$\delta(1,2) = \tfrac{2}{9}(\ell_1 - \ell_2)\log A_{12} + \tfrac{2}{3}M_1 M_2(v_1 - v_2),$$

where ℓ is the soliton's spectral parameter, A_{12} the Hirota interaction constant and v_j the velocities. The phase is antisymmetric and obeys a crossing-type relation. For the bad equation, the coefficient of $\log A_{12}$ continued to breather kinematics equals the breather adiabatic invariant of Bogdan and Charkina, so Bohr–Sommerfeld quantisation becomes a string condition in ℓ; and the classical limit of the quantum Toda Bethe ansatz reproduces δ, including its topological term, in the small-amplitude limit. For the good equation with Corrigan–Zambon integrable defects, the soliton–defect transmission phase has the same structure, the defect adds no cross terms, two-soliton–defect scattering factorises, exactly one defect vacuum in each KP triple is linearly stable, and the tree-level phases obey an exact fusion identity. We also record two structural results: the Lax connection is non-ultralocal, and A_{12} factorises into $\mathfrak{sl}_3$ affine Toda blocks of $\beta_1 \pm \beta_2$. One-loop corrections, the quantum Toda Fermi-edge limit and exact S-matrices are not settled; their status is summarised as placeholders.

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1 Introduction

1.1 The problem

The quantum theory of solitons in integrable relativistic field theories is well developed. The semiclassical scattering phase of two solitons follows from their classical time delays **(a)** [16], and in sine-Gordon and the affine Toda theories exact soliton S-matrices have been proposed and tested against unitarity, crossing, Yang–Baxter and bootstrap requirements **(b)** [23, 24, 17].

The Boussinesq equation is the simplest integrable bidirectional wave equation and has N-soliton solutions **(a)** [20]. Its quantum soliton sector is much less understood. A systematic search of the literature found no two-soliton S-matrix, or non-relativistic two-body scattering phase, for either sign of the dispersion (search coverage and caveats in the project's literature map, `phase0/literature_map.md`). Corrigan and Zambon note that the Boussinesq S-matrix deserves further study because of classical solutions that do not conserve the number of solitons **(b)** [12, §6]. The only earlier quantisation of a Boussinesq soliton that we know of is the one-body Bohr–Sommerfeld quantisation of the breather of the bad equation by Bogdan and Charkina **(a)** [4].

This paper consolidates what can be established about two-body scattering of Boussinesq solitons at the semiclassical order $O(\hbar^{-1})$ in the phase, and states what remains open at higher orders.

1.2 Why Boussinesq differs from KdV and sine-Gordon

- *No boost symmetry.* The two-soliton interaction constant depends separately on $\alpha_1 + \alpha_2$ and $\alpha_1 - \alpha_2$ (Section 2.4) **(c)**. A soliton S-matrix is therefore a genuine function of two momenta. It cannot be a function of a rapidity difference, and the usual form of crossing must be replaced.

- *Gapless phonons.* The linearised good equation has $\omega^2 = q^2 + q^4$. Solitons of the good equation are subsonic, those of the bad equation supersonic **(a)**/**(c)**. There is no mass gap, so the relativistic one-loop machinery does not apply unchanged.

- *A continuous topological charge.* In the potential ϕ with $u = \phi_x$, a soliton is a kink of height $M = 2k$, which varies with the soliton's parameter **(c)**. In sine-Gordon the kink height is fixed. This difference produces the cross terms that are central to Section 3.

- *Number-changing classical solutions.* The good equation has resonant (Y-shaped) solutions in which two solitons merge into one, virtual solitons in head-on collisions, and singular two-soliton solutions in part of parameter space **(a)** [21, 26, 31, 15]. Corrigan–Zambon defects can reflect solitons or decay into them **(a)** [12]. None of this occurs for KdV or sine-Gordon. Purely elastic, factorised quantum scattering is therefore not guaranteed **(b)** [12].

- *Energy unbounded below; two real forms.* In both forms the Hamiltonian is unbounded below **(c)**. The good and bad equations are the same complexified flow with real or imaginary time (Section 2). The good equation is well posed **(a)** [5] and carries the Corrigan–Zambon defects **(a)** [12]. The bad equation is Hadamard ill-posed **(a)** [9], but it has a rigorous inverse scattering theory with solitons on an invariant class of data **(a)** [9, 10, 11], regular breathers **(a)** [10, 4], and it is the small-amplitude continuum limit of the Toda lattice **(a)** [36].

1.3 Prior work

Classical theory. The Lax pair is due to Zakharov [36]; the direct and inverse scattering theory is in [13] and, with solitons and breathers for the bad equation, in the work of Charlier and Lenells [9, 10, 11]; their good-equation analysis [8] is solitonless **(a)**. Hirota's bilinear method gives the N-soliton solutions **(a)** [20]. Soliton resonances and merging solitons are due to Hirota and Ito [21], Lambert, Musette and Kesteloot [26], and Rasin and Schiff [31]; the matrix good equation and its tropical limit, including virtual solitons, are treated by Dimakis, Müller-Hoissen and Chen [15]. Bonnemain and Doyon develop the generalised hydrodynamics of the good soliton gas [6] and observe that, unlike KdV, Boussinesq distinguishes between candidate choices of soliton "momentum" **(b)**.

Quantum theory. The quantum Boussinesq charges are the commuting charges of W_3 conformal field theory **(a)** [25, 7, 3, 28, 1, 2]; these live on a circle in highest-weight modules and have no asymptotic particle states. Hikami constructs a Baxter Q-operator for a periodic quantum discrete Boussinesq chain **(a)** [19], without a particle sector. The quantum Toda chain is exactly solvable **(a)** [18, 33], its asymptotic Bethe ansatz is due to Sutherland and Mertens [34, 29], and its particle excitations become classical solitons **(b)** [29, 32, 30]. Pustilnik and Matveev analyse the classical-to-quantum crossover of KdV solitons in quantum Toda and Lieb–Liniger **(b)** [30]. Soliton S-matrices of imaginary-coupling $a_n^{(1)}$ affine Toda theories are built from $U_q(\widehat{\mathfrak{sl}}_n)$ intertwiners **(b)** [22, 23, 24, 17], with the caveat that $a_2^{(1)}$ soliton–breather scattering is flawed **(b)** [35]. Bogdan and Charkina quantise the breather of the bad equation by Bohr–Sommerfeld **(a)** [4]. Corrigan and Zambon construct integrable type-I defects for the good equation **(a)** [12].

1.4 Summary of results

All results below are at the semiclassical order and are labelled by the equation they hold for.

1. [good & bad] With the potential normalised at $x \to -\infty$, the canonical symplectic form on well-separated solitons contains ordering-dependent cross terms $d\Pi_i \wedge dM_j$. Two-soliton scattering preserves it exactly, while without the cross terms the scattering map is not symplectic (Propositions 3.1–3.2) **(c)**.

2. [good & bad] The semiclassical phase is $\delta(1,2) = \frac{2}{9}(\ell_1 - \ell_2)\log A_{12} + \frac{2}{3}M_1M_2(v_1 - v_2)$ in both orientations (Proposition 4.1) **(c)**. It is antisymmetric, obeys a crossing-type relation, and stays finite on the resonance lines (Proposition 4.2) **(c)**.

3. [bad] At breather kinematics, $i \cdot \frac{2}{9}(\ell_1 - \ell_2)$ equals the Bogdan–Charkina adiabatic invariant exactly, so breather quantisation is the string condition $\ell_1 - \ell_2 = -\frac{9i}{2}N\hbar$ (Proposition 4.3) **(c)**.

4. [bad] The classical limit of the quantum Toda Bethe ansatz reproduces the Toda soliton sector with its cross terms, and its label-frame phase tends to $3b\,\delta_{\mathrm{bad}}$ in the Boussinesq limit for both orientations (Propositions 4.4–4.6) **(c)**.

5. [good] For Corrigan–Zambon defects: the transmission phase δ_D has the form of δ with the defect as a particle of spectral parameter $\ell(q)$; there are no defect cross terms; two-soliton–defect scattering is symplectic and factorises; a vacuum is linearly stable iff $\eta\sigma < -1$; and tree-level phases obey an exact fusion identity (Section 5) **(c)**.

6. [good & bad] The Lax connection is non-ultralocal; A_{12} is a ratio of $\mathfrak{sl}_3$ affine Toda and sine-Gordon blocks in $\beta_1 + \beta_2$ and $\beta_1 - \beta_2$; and no S-matrix of the form $F(\beta_1 - \beta_2)G(\beta_1 + \beta_2)$ has the semiclassical limit $e^{i\delta/\hbar}$ (Section 6) **(c)**.

We do *not* claim a one-loop S-matrix, an exact S-matrix, or a quantum matching to the Toda chain beyond its classical limit (Sections 7–9).

Labels and verification. Every nontrivial claim carries a label: **(a)** proved in the literature; **(b)** conjectured or heuristic in the literature; **(c)** derived in this project; **(d)** a guess. Each **(c)** formula has been checked by a Python (SymPy/mpmath) script in the project repository; the script is named in a footnote and all are listed in Appendix A. Inconsistencies found between the project's write-ups while preparing this draft are listed in Appendix B.

2 Conventions and the classical soliton sector

2.1 The two equations and their canonical structure

The *good* Boussinesq equation, its potential and its Hirota form are

$$u_{tt} = u_{xx} - u_{xxxx} - 3(u^2)_{xx}, \qquad u = \phi_x = 2(\log\tau)_{xx}, \qquad (D_t^2 - D_x^2 + D_x^4)\,\tau\cdot\tau = 0. \tag{1}$$

The *bad* equation is

$$v_{tt} = v_{xx} + v_{xxxx} + 3(v^2)_{xx}, \qquad v = \phi_x = 2(\log\tau)_{xx}, \qquad (D_t^2 - D_x^2 - D_x^4)\,\tau\cdot\tau = 0. \tag{2}$$

The sign of the nonlinear terms is fixed so that solitons are positive **(c)**.[1] The equations are the Euler–Lagrange equations of

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{good}} = \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_t^2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 + \phi_x^3 - \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2, \qquad \mathcal{L}_{\text{bad}} = \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_t^2 - \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 - \phi_x^3 + \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2 \tag{3}$$

(c).[2] The canonical momentum is $\pi = \phi_t$, the symplectic form is

$$\Omega = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} d\pi \wedge d\phi\, dx, \tag{4}$$

and $\hbar$ always refers to this normalisation. The conserved quantities used below are

$$M = \int u\,dx, \qquad \Pi = \int \pi\,dx, \qquad P = -\int \pi\,\phi_x\,dx, \qquad E = \int \Big(\tfrac{1}{2}\pi^2 + \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 \mp \phi_x^3 \pm \tfrac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2\Big)dx, \tag{5}$$

with the upper signs for the good equation. M is the topological charge (the height of the kink in ϕ), Π is the charge of the shift symmetry $\phi \to \phi + c$, and P generates translations **(c)**. Both Hamiltonians are unbounded below: the cubic term does this in both forms, and in the bad form the quadratic term $-\frac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2$ already does **(c)** (elementary).

Linear waves. Phonons $e^{i(qx-\omega t)}$ obey $\omega^2 = q^2 + q^4$ (good) and $\omega^2 = q^2 - q^4$ (bad). In the bad equation modes with $|q| > 1$ grow at an unbounded rate, so its Cauchy problem is ill-posed in Sobolev spaces **(a)** [6, 9]. Charlier and Lenells nevertheless prove global existence on the class of data whose reflection coefficient vanishes on the unstable set, and extend this to solitons **(a)** [9, Thms 2.8–2.12], [10]. The good equation is locally well posed, and globally for small data **(a)** [5].

Real and imaginary time. Let $L = \partial_x^3 + q_L\partial_x + r_L$ and $M_L = (L^{2/3})_+ = \partial_x^2 + \frac{2}{3}q_L$. Then $L_\tau = [M_L, L]$ implies $q_{L,\tau\tau} = -\frac{1}{3}q_{L,xxxx} - \frac{2}{3}(q_L^2)_{xx}$ **(a)** [36]/**(c)**. With $q_L = \frac{3}{2}u - \frac{1}{4}$ and $\tau = \sqrt{3}\,t$ this is the good equation; with $q_L = \frac{3}{2}v + \frac{1}{4}$ and $\tau = i\sqrt{3}\,t$ it is the bad one **(c)**.[3] Both are therefore the same complexified flow on third-order operators; they differ in the real form of time and in the background q_L, which generates the sound term. The chiral W_3 literature [3] never has to make this choice.

2.2 One-soliton solutions and their charges

The one-soliton is

$$\tau = 1 + e^{\theta}, \qquad \theta = kx - \omega t + x_0, \qquad \omega = kv, \qquad u = \frac{k^2}{2}\operatorname{sech}^2\frac{\theta}{2}, \tag{6}$$

[1] Verification: `phase0/checks/convention_check.py`, `phase1/scripts/hirota_solitons.py`, `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (checks 1–2).

[2] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py` (good); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 1, both). The sign of ϕ_x^3 in $\mathcal{L}_{\text{bad}}$ differs from the master report; see Appendix B, item 1..

[3] Verification: `phase1/scripts/lax_zero_curvature.py`.

with direction $\epsilon = \pm 1$ and the uniformisations

$$\text{good: } k = \sin\alpha, \quad v = \epsilon\cos\alpha, \quad \alpha \in (0, \tfrac{\pi}{2}); \qquad \text{bad: } k = \sinh\beta, \quad v = \epsilon\cosh\beta, \quad \beta > 0. \tag{7}$$

Good solitons are subsonic, and larger ones are slower; bad solitons are supersonic **(a)**/**(c)**.[4] The charges (5) on a soliton are

$$M = 2k, \qquad \Pi = -Mv, \qquad P = \tfrac{2}{3}k^3 v, \qquad E = \tfrac{2}{15}k^3(5 \mp 4k^2), \qquad \frac{dE}{dP} = v, \tag{8}$$

(c).[5] The bad-equation values of E and P agree with Bogdan and Charkina **(a)** [4, (14),(16),(18)], and the good ones with Corrigan and Zambon after the map of Section 5 **(a)**/**(c)**. The derivatives

$$\frac{dP}{d\alpha} = \tfrac{2}{3}\epsilon\sin\alpha\sin 3\alpha \quad \text{(good)}, \qquad \frac{dP}{d\beta} = \tfrac{2}{3}\epsilon\sinh\beta\sinh 3\beta \quad \text{(bad)} \tag{9}$$

recur below **(c)**.[6]

Proposition 2.1 ([good], **(c)**). *The good one-soliton momentum is bounded, $|P| \le \sqrt{3}/8$, with the maximum at the cusp $\alpha = \pi/3$ ($k = \sqrt{3}/2$, $|v| = \frac{1}{2}$). The light branch $\alpha < \pi/3$ is KdV-like; the heavy branch $\alpha > \pi/3$ is a non-relativistic particle with $E = \frac{2}{15} + \frac{3}{4}P^2 + \dots$. The canonical form (4) pulled back to the one-soliton family is $\pm P'(k)\,dk \wedge dx_0$ and degenerates at the cusp.*[7]

For the bad equation $E(P)$ is monotone **(a)** [4]. Figure 1 (right) shows the good dispersion relation.

2.3 KP roots, chords and the spectral parameter

Good equation. Attach to a soliton the two numbers

$$p_a = \tfrac{1}{2}\Big(k + \frac{v}{\sqrt{3}}\Big), \qquad p_b = \tfrac{1}{2}\Big(\frac{v}{\sqrt{3}} - k\Big), \qquad p_a - p_b = k, \qquad p_a^2 + p_a p_b + p_b^2 = \tfrac{1}{4}. \tag{10}$$

They are two roots of the cubic

$$\ell(p) \equiv -3\sqrt{3}\,p\,(1 - 4p^2) = \ell, \qquad \ell = -\epsilon\cos 3\alpha, \tag{11}$$

whose third root is $p_c = -p_a - p_b = -v/\sqrt{3}$ **(c)**.[8] We call ℓ the *spectral parameter*: with the Lax normalisation above, $e^{\mu x}$ is an eigenfunction of L on the vacuum with eigenvalue $\lambda = \mu^3 - \mu/4$, the soliton corresponds to the pair of sheets $\mu = -p_a, -p_b$, and $\lambda = -\ell/(12\sqrt{3})$ **(c)**.[9] In the KP picture a soliton is a line soliton labelled by two roots **(a)** [15], so a Boussinesq soliton is a *chord* (p_a, p_b) of a KP triple $\{p_a, p_b, p_c\}$. The three chords of one triple are three solitons with the same ℓ; they are the three legs of a resonant Y-junction, and Rasin and Schiff's "conservation of speed" $\lambda_1 + \lambda_2 + \lambda_3 = 0$ **(a)** [31, §3] is the statement that they use the three roots of one cubic **(c)** (identification).

[4] Verification: `phase1/scripts/hirota_solitons.py`; cf. [6, (18)], [12, (2.8)], [4, (11)].

[5] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py`; `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 3, 40-digit quadrature for both equations and both directions).

[6] Verification: `phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py`; `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 9).

[7] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py`.

[8] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (check 2); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 4).

[9] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py` (spectral picture); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 4, including the sign relation $\mu = -p$ between the Phase 1 and Phase 2 root variables).

Bad equation. The corresponding roots are complex, $\mu_{a,b} = \frac{1}{2}(iv/\sqrt{3} \pm k)$, roots of $\mu^3 + \frac{1}{4}\mu = \frac{i}{12\sqrt{3}}\ell$ with $\ell = \epsilon \cosh 3\beta$ **(c)**.[10] For the bad equation, ℓ is proportional to the spectral parameter in the uniformisation $\lambda = \frac{1}{2}(k^3 + k^{-3})$ of [9], with k^3 in the role of $e^{3\beta}$ **(c)**.

Gelfand–Dickey charges and missing spins. [good] The Gelfand–Dickey hierarchy charges $H_n = \int \operatorname{Res} L^{n/3}\, dx$ vanish identically for $n \equiv 0 \pmod 3$ because L^m is a differential operator **(a)** [14] (verified for $n \le 6$ **(c)**).[11] On a one-soliton with roots $\mu_{1,2}$ ($\mu_1 - \mu_2 = k$, $\mu_1 + \mu_2 = -v/\sqrt{3}$) and $\Delta_m = \mu_1^m - \mu_2^m$, the lowest nontrivial charges are $H_1 = \Delta_1$, $H_2 = \Delta_2$, $H_4 = \Delta_4 - \frac{1}{3}\Delta_2$, $H_5 = \Delta_5 - \frac{5}{72}\Delta_1$, and the physical charges are $P = -2\sqrt{3}\, H_4 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} H_2$ and $E = \frac{24}{5} H_5 + \frac{1}{6} H_1$ **(c)**.[12] Because μ_j obey the cubic $\mu^3 = \frac{1}{4}\mu + \lambda$, $\Delta_3 = \frac{1}{4}\Delta_1$ is not independent.

2.4 Two-soliton solutions and phase shifts

The N-soliton solution is

$$\tau = \sum_{\mu \in \{0,1\}^N} \exp\Big(\sum_i \mu_i \theta_i + \sum_{i<j} \mu_i \mu_j \log A_{ij} \Big), \qquad A_{ij} = -\frac{\mathcal{P}(k_i - k_j, \omega_i - \omega_j)}{\mathcal{P}(k_i + k_j, \omega_i + \omega_j)}, \tag{12}$$

with $\mathcal{P}(K, W) = W^2 - K^2 \pm K^4$ (upper sign good) **(a)** [20]. The bilinear condition holds exactly for $N \le 4$ in all direction patterns **(c)**.[13] Position shifts are pairwise additive, so classical scattering of pure solitons is factorised **(a)**/**(c)**.

Proposition 2.2 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *Let $S = \alpha_1 + \alpha_2$, $D = \alpha_1 - \alpha_2$ (good) or $S = \beta_1 + \beta_2$, $D = \beta_1 - \beta_2$ (bad), with soliton 1 right-moving. Then*

$$\textit{good:}\quad A_{\mathrm{ov}} = \frac{1 - 3\cot^2\frac{S}{2}}{1 - 3\cot^2\frac{D}{2}}, \qquad A_{\mathrm{ho}} = \frac{1 - 3\tan^2\frac{D}{2}}{1 - 3\tan^2\frac{S}{2}}, \tag{13}$$

$$\textit{bad:}\quad A_{\mathrm{ov}} = \frac{1 + 3\coth^2\frac{S}{2}}{1 + 3\coth^2\frac{D}{2}}, \qquad A_{\mathrm{ho}} = \frac{1 + 3\tanh^2\frac{D}{2}}{1 + 3\tanh^2\frac{S}{2}}, \tag{14}$$

for overtaking ($\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2$) and head-on ($\epsilon_1 = -\epsilon_2$) collisions. In both equations A_{12} is the cross-ratio of the roots,

$$A_{12} = \frac{(p_{1a} - p_{2a})(p_{1b} - p_{2b})}{(p_{1a} - p_{2b})(p_{1b} - p_{2a})}. \tag{15}$$

[14]

A_{12} agrees with Bonnemain–Doyon's eq. (16) **(a)** [6]/**(c)**. The bad constants lie in $(0, 1)$ **(c)**. The dependence on both S and D is the classical signature of the missing boost symmetry.

Proposition 2.3 ([good], **(c)**). *For the good equation (Fig. 1):*

1. *overtaking collisions are regular iff $\alpha_1 + \alpha_2 < \frac{2\pi}{3}$, and are then repulsive ($0 < A < 1$);*
2. *head-on collisions are regular and attractive ($A > 1$) for $\alpha_1 + \alpha_2 < \frac{\pi}{3}$, regular and repulsive for $|\alpha_1 - \alpha_2| > \frac{\pi}{3}$, and singular otherwise;*

[10] Verification: `phase2/scripts/smatrix_ansatz.py`; `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 5).
[11] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py`.
[12] Verification: `phase1/scripts/charges.py`.
[13] Verification: `phase1/scripts/hirota_solitons.py`.
[14] Verification: `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`; `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (check 1); `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 5, bad); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 4, good).

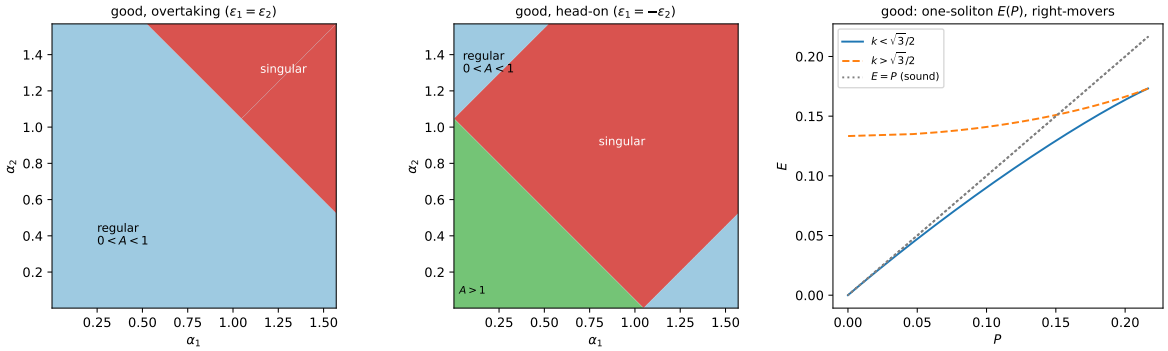


Figure 1: [good] *Left and centre:* regularity of the two-soliton solution in the (α_1, α_2) plane for overtaking and head-on collisions. Red: singular ($A < 0$). Blue: regular and repulsive ($0 < A < 1$). Green: regular and attractive ($A > 1$). The boundaries are resonance lines. *Right:* the one-soliton dispersion $E(P)$, with the light branch (solid) and heavy branch (dashed) meeting at the cusp $k = \sqrt{3}/2$. Figure from `phase1/scripts/figures.py`.

3. *on each resonance line ($A = 0$ or ∞) the sum or difference of the two solitons' (k, ω) satisfies the soliton dispersion relation, and the degenerate τ-function describes a Y-junction in which two solitons merge or one splits.*

[15]

These regions agree with the conditions of Lambert, Musette and Kesteloot as quoted in [6, (29)–(33)] **(a)**/**(c)**. In root language a resonance line is where two roots of different solitons coincide, so that $\ell_1 = \ell_2$ **(c)**.[16]

Position shifts. If soliton 1 starts on the left, the asymptotic position shifts are

$$\Delta x_1 = -k_1^{-1} \log A_{12}, \qquad \Delta x_2 = +k_2^{-1} \log A_{12} \tag{16}$$

(c), checked against peak tracking of exact solutions in overtaking and attractive and repulsive head-on cases.[17] For small amplitudes the overtaking shift reduces to the KdV value $2 \log |\frac{k_1 - k_2}{k_1 + k_2}|$, while the head-on $\log A_{12} \to 0$ **(a)** [6].

2.5 Breathers

A breather is the real reduction $k_2 = \bar{k}_1$, $\omega_2 = \bar{\omega}_1$ of the two-soliton. It is regular iff $A(k, \bar{k}) > 1$.

Proposition 2.4 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *1.* [good] *For $\alpha = a + ib$, $A(k, \bar{k}) = \dfrac{1 - 3\cot^2 a}{1 + 3\coth^2 b} < \frac{1}{4}$. Every Hirota breather of the good equation on the zero background is singular.*

2. [bad] *For $\beta_{1,2} = a \pm ib$ (Bogdan–Charkina's parametrisation $\kappa \pm ik = \sinh(a \pm ib)$), A_{12} equals their a_{12} [4, (33)], and the breather is regular iff $b > \pi/3$, which is their existence boundary $\pi/3 < b \le \pi/2$* **(a)** *[4, (29)–(41)].*

[18]

Item 1 concerns the two-phase Hirota class on the zero background only. For the bad equation, breathers from the regular region of Charlier and Lenells are smooth for all t and those from the singular region are singular at every t **(a)** [10, Lemma A.4].

[15] Verification: `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py` (400^2 grid).
[16] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (check 5).
[17] Verification: `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`.
[18] Verification: `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py` (good; grid and complex-k scan); `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 4, bad).

Table 1: Dictionary between the good and bad equations. Entries are **(c)** unless marked; the last three rows summarise Sections 2.5, 4.4 and 5.

	good	bad
Equation	$u_{tt} = u_{xx} - u_{xxxx} - 3(u^2)_{xx}$	$v_{tt} = v_{xx} + v_{xxxx} + 3(v^2)_{xx}$
Lagrangian	$\frac{1}{2}\phi_t^2 - \frac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 + \phi_x^3 - \frac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2$	$\frac{1}{2}\phi_t^2 - \frac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 - \phi_x^3 + \frac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2$
Phonons	$\omega^2 = q^2 + q^4$	$\omega^2 = q^2 - q^4$
Lax form	$q_L = \frac{3}{2}u - \frac{1}{4}$, $\tau = \sqrt{3}t$	$q_L = \frac{3}{2}v + \frac{1}{4}$, $\tau = i\sqrt{3}t$
Rapidity	$k = \sin\alpha$, $\alpha \in (0, \frac{\pi}{2})$	$k = \sinh\beta$, $\beta > 0$
Velocity	$v = \epsilon\cos\alpha$ (subsonic)	$v = \epsilon\cosh\beta$ (supersonic)
Spectral parameter	$\ell = -\epsilon\cos 3\alpha$	$\ell = \epsilon\cosh 3\beta$
M, Π	$2\sin\alpha$, $-\epsilon\sin 2\alpha$	$2\sinh\beta$, $-\epsilon\sinh 2\beta$
P	$\frac{2}{3}\epsilon\sin^3\alpha\cos\alpha$ (bounded)	$\frac{2}{3}\epsilon\sinh^3\beta\cosh\beta$
E	$\frac{2}{15}k^3(5 - 4k^2)$	$\frac{2}{15}k^3(5 + 4k^2)$
dP/d(rapidity)	$\frac{2}{3}\epsilon\sin\alpha\sin 3\alpha$	$\frac{2}{3}\epsilon\sinh\beta\sinh 3\beta$
A_{ov}; A_{ho}	(13)	(14)
Roots	real, $\frac{1}{2}(\pm k + v/\sqrt{3})$	complex, $\frac{1}{2}(iv/\sqrt{3} \pm k)$
Crossing map	$\alpha \to \alpha + \pi$	$\beta \to \beta + i\pi$
Two-soliton regularity	regions, resonances (Prop. 2.3)	always regular, $0 < A < 1$
Regular breathers	none (Hirota class)	for $b > \pi/3$ **(a)** [4]
Toda continuum limit	—	small amplitudes **(a)** [36]
CZ type-I defects	exist **(a)** [12]	no real type-I defect for $\lambda_{\mathrm{CZ}} \neq 0$

2.6 The good/bad dictionary

Table 1 collects the corresponding quantities. Results in this paper are stated for one equation or for both, as tagged.

Remark 2.5 ([good & bad], **(c)**). The substitution $\alpha = i\beta$ maps the good-equation soliton data to the bad ones according to

$$(k,\, M,\, \Pi,\, P,\, E,\, \ell,\, v,\, A_{12})\big|_{\mathrm{good}} \;\longmapsto\; (ik,\, iM,\, i\Pi,\, -iP,\, -iE,\, -\ell,\, v,\, A_{12})\big|_{\mathrm{bad}},$$

in both orientations; consequently the semiclassical phase (21) below satisfies $\delta_{\mathrm{good}}(i\beta_1, i\beta_2) = -\delta_{\mathrm{bad}}(\beta_1, \beta_2)$.[19] This explains why a single formula covers both equations. It is a statement about formulas, not a map between real solutions.

3 Canonical structure and exact symplecticity of scattering

3.1 Cross terms in the symplectic form

Consider N well-separated solitons at positions X_j with parameters k_j, and normalise the potential by $\phi(-\infty) = c$. Then ϕ is a sum of kinks, ϕ_j rising from 0 to M_j across X_j, plus c.

Proposition 3.1 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *Up to exponentially small terms,*

$$\Omega = d\Pi_{\mathrm{tot}} \wedge dc + \sum_j dP_j \wedge dX_j + \sum_{i \neq j} \big[X_i > X_j\big]\, d\Pi_i \wedge dM_j. \tag{17}$$

[19] Verification: `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 5); the statement for A_{12} is in `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`.

The momentum density π_i of soliton i is localised at X_i, where ϕ_j equals 0 or M_j according to whether soliton i is left or right of soliton j. This gives the cross terms. The diagonal term is the one-soliton result of Proposition 2.1. In sine-Gordon the analogous cross term vanishes because the kink height $2\pi/\beta$ is fixed; here $M = 2k$ varies **(c)**.

3.2 Scattering is symplectic only with the cross terms

During a collision the parameters k_j and the constant c are conserved and $X_j \mapsto X_j + \Delta x_j$ with (16). Soliton 1 starts on the left and ends on the right, so the cross term changes from $d\Pi_2 \wedge dM_1$ to $d\Pi_1 \wedge dM_2$.

Proposition 3.2 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *The two-soliton scattering map preserves* (17)*:*

$$\sum_j dP_j \wedge d\Delta x_j = d\Pi_2 \wedge dM_1 - d\Pi_1 \wedge dM_2. \tag{18}$$

Without the cross terms the left side would have to vanish; it does not (for example it equals 19.79 *at* $\beta = (0.9, 0.3)$ *in the bad equation).*[20]

Equation (18) shows that the naive rule $\Delta x_j = -\partial\delta/\partial P_j$ cannot hold for any function δ: the shifts are not curl-free in the canonical momenta. The same identity holds on the Toda lattice in label coordinates (Proposition 4.5).

3.3 Darboux coordinates

In each ordering region define

$$X'_j = X_j + \gamma_j \sum_{i \text{ left of } j} M_i, \qquad \gamma_j = \frac{d\Pi_j/dk_j}{dP_j/dk_j} \tag{19}$$

(c). For the good equation $\gamma = -3\cos 2\alpha/(\sin\alpha \sin 3\alpha)$, which has a pole at the cusp **(c)**.[21] In these coordinates the cross terms are absorbed, and the shifts

$$\Delta X'_1 = -\frac{\log A_{12}}{k_1} + \gamma_1 M_2, \qquad \Delta X'_2 = +\frac{\log A_{12}}{k_2} - \gamma_2 M_1 \tag{20}$$

are curl-free in (P_1, P_2) **(c)**. Normalising ϕ at $+\infty$ instead gives the same in–out differences **(c)**.[22]

4 The semiclassical two-soliton phase

4.1 The phase

By stationary phase on two-particle wave packets, a phase δ with $\Delta X'_j = -\partial\delta/\partial P_j$ gives the leading semiclassical S-matrix $S \simeq e^{i\delta/\hbar}$ **(a)** [16].

Proposition 4.1 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *For overtaking and head-on collisions, in both equations,*

$$\boxed{\delta(1,2) = \tfrac{2}{9}\,(\ell_1 - \ell_2)\,\log A_{12} + \tfrac{2}{3}\,M_1 M_2\,(v_1 - v_2)} \tag{21}$$

[20] Verification: Bad: `phase2/scripts/symplectic_scattering.py` (40 digits; overtaking and head-on, several points each). Good, regular region: `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (double precision) and `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (check 3, 10^{-40}, with a defect present).

[21] Verification: `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 9).

[22] Verification: `phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py`, `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 1).

with $\ell = -\epsilon\cos 3\alpha$ *(good) or* $\ell = \epsilon\cosh 3\beta$ *(bad). The second term can be written* $T_{12} \equiv \frac{2}{3}M_1M_2(v_1 - v_2) = -\frac{2}{3}(\Pi_1 M_2 - \Pi_2 M_1)$*. For the good equation the statement holds in the regular region* ($\alpha_j < \pi/3$, $A_{12} > 0$)*.*[23]

The remainder T_{12} was first found by symbolic integration and then identified exactly **(c)**. Three remarks:

- The dynamical part is (difference of spectral parameters)$\times \log A_{12}$. Because $dP \propto k\sinh 3\beta\, d\beta$ (or $k\sin 3\alpha\, d\alpha$), integration by parts closes and the tree-level phase is elementary: no dilogarithm appears at $O(\hbar^{-1})$, in contrast to relativistic affine Toda theory **(c)** [23, 24].
- T_{12} is an Aharonov–Bohm-like "mutual statistics" phase between objects carrying shift charge Π and winding M **(d)** (interpretation).
- The same structure, (difference of spectral parameters)$\times \log A$ minus a multiple of $\Pi_1 M_2 - \Pi_2 M_1$, appears on the Toda lattice (Proposition 4.5). We conjecture that it is universal for integrable models with a continuous kink charge, KdV included **(d)**.

4.2 Properties

Proposition 4.2 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *1.* Unitarity: $\delta(1,2) = -\delta(2,1)$.

2. Crossing-type relation: $\delta_{\rm ov}(\beta_1, \beta_2 + i\pi) = -\delta_{\rm ho}(\beta_1, \beta_2)$ *(bad) and* $\delta_{\rm ov}(\alpha_1, \alpha_2 + \pi) = -\delta_{\rm ho}(\alpha_1, \alpha_2)$ *(good, regular head-on region). The shift maps a right-mover to a left-mover with* $(k, M, \ell) \to (-k, -M, -\ell)$ *and* $A_{\rm ov} \to 1/A_{\rm ho}$*.*

3. [good] Resonance lines: *where* $A_{12} \to 0$ *or* ∞ *one has* $\ell_1 = \ell_2$*, so* $\delta \to T_{12}$ *stays finite while the delays diverge logarithmically.*

4. [good] Cusp: *at* $\alpha = \pi/3$, $dP/d\alpha = 0$*;* δ *is smooth in* α *but has a square-root branch point as a function of* P*.*

[24]

Near the cusp the wave-packet derivation needs a uniform (Airy-type) treatment, and α or the root, rather than P, is the natural label **(d)**. Past the resonance lines lie the Y-shaped solutions, which are outside the two-particle description.

Small amplitudes. [bad] For overtaking collisions with $\beta_1/\beta_2 = 1.7$ fixed and $\beta_j \to 0$, the ratio of $\partial\delta/\partial\beta_1$ to the KdV-type term $2\beta_1 \log A_{12}$ tends to $0.5642\ldots = 1 + 2\beta_2/(\beta_1 \log A_{\rm KdV})$, with $A_{\rm KdV} = (\frac{\beta_1-\beta_2}{\beta_1+\beta_2})^2$. The cross-term contribution $-(d\Pi_1/d\beta_1)M_2 \to 4\beta_2$ to the Darboux shift (20) is of the same order as the KdV-type term **(c)**.[25] The heuristic of Bonnemain and Doyon identifies the quantum phase derivative with $P'_{\rm GHD}\Delta x$, with $P_{\rm GHD} = \eta^2/2$ **(b)** [6]. It reproduces the dynamical term but misses the cross-term contribution **(c)**; their classical hydrodynamics, which uses only Δx, is unaffected. [good & bad] For head-on collisions $\delta \to 4\beta_1\beta_2$, of which $\frac{16}{3}\beta_1\beta_2$ comes from T_{12} and $-\frac{4}{3}\beta_1\beta_2$ from the dynamical term (and likewise with α_j for the good equation) **(c)**.[26]

[23] Verification: `phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py` (symbolic integration of the Darboux shifts); `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 1, gradient test for both equations and orientations).

[24] Verification: Items 1–2: `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (unitarity asserted; bad crossing printed) and `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 6, both asserted at 40 digits). Items 3–4: `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (check 5).

[25] Verification: `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 6, reported as a finding); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 7, limit identified and asserted).

[26] Verification: `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 7).

4.3 Bad equation: breathers as spectral-parameter strings

Bogdan and Charkina quantise the Tajiri–Murakami breather of the bad equation by the Bohr–Sommerfeld rule $I_{\mathrm{br}} = N\hbar$, with an independently computed adiabatic invariant I_{br}, and verify $dE = \tilde{\omega}\, dN + V\, dP$ **(a)** [4, (64)–(71)].

Proposition 4.3 ([bad], **(c)**). *At $\beta_{1,2} = a \pm ib$,*

$$i \cdot \tfrac{2}{9}(\ell_1 - \ell_2) = -\tfrac{4}{9} \sinh 3a \, \sin 3b = I_{\mathrm{br}}, \tag{22}$$

the Bogdan–Charkina invariant [4, (64)]. Hence the coefficient of $\log A_{12}$ *in* (21) *is the breather action, and Bohr–Sommerfeld quantisation reads*

$$\ell_1 - \ell_2 = -\tfrac{9i}{2}\, N\hbar, \qquad N \in \mathbb{N}. \tag{23}$$

[27]

This ties the phase (21), built from Hirota shifts and the canonical symplectic form, to an independent quasiclassical calculation in the literature. Equation (23) is a string condition in the spectral parameter, the form in which bound states appear in Bethe-ansatz solvable models. It suggests that an exact S-matrix has poles at $\ell_1 - \ell_2 \in -\frac{9i}{2}\hbar\mathbb{N}$, possibly with a renormalised $\hbar$ **(d)**. The good equation has no regular breathers (Proposition 2.4), so there is no analogue of this check there.

4.4 Bad equation: the classical limit of the quantum Toda Bethe ansatz

Set-up. The Toda chain is $H = \sum_n (\frac{1}{2}p_n^2 + e^{-r_n})$ with $r_n = x_{n+1} - x_n$, mean spacing a and $b = e^{-a/2}$. Its small-amplitude long-wave limit is the bad equation **(a)** [36, 4]/**(c)**.[28] The one-soliton is $e^{-r_n} = b^2[1 + \sinh^2\kappa \, \mathrm{sech}^2(\kappa n - sbt \sinh\kappa)]$, $s = \pm 1$, with

$$M = \sum (r_n - a) = -2\kappa, \qquad \Pi = \sum p_n = 2sb \sinh\kappa, \qquad E = 2b^2(\sinh\kappa\cosh\kappa - \kappa),$$

where $E = \sum[\frac{1}{2}p_n^2 + e^{-r_n} - b^2 + b^2(r_n - a)]$. The canonical form $\sum dp_n \wedge dx_n$ pulled back to (κ, n_0) is $dP_n \wedge dn_0$ with label momentum $P_n = 4sb(\kappa\cosh\kappa - \sinh\kappa)$, and $dE/dP_n = b\sinh\kappa/\kappa$ is the label velocity **(c)**.[29] The two-soliton constant is $A_T = -\mathcal{P}_T(2\kappa_1 - 2\kappa_2, \omega_1 - \omega_2)/\mathcal{P}_T(2\kappa_1 + 2\kappa_2, \omega_1 + \omega_2)$ with $\mathcal{P}_T(K, W) = W^2 - 4b^2\sinh^2(K/2)$ and $\omega = 2sb\sinh\kappa$ **(c)**.[30]

The relative two-body problem $H = q^2 + e^{-x}$ has reflection amplitude $R = \Gamma(i\kappa)\hbar^{2i\kappa}/\Gamma(-i\kappa)$, $\kappa = \Delta p/\hbar$ (standard; derived in the project but not compared line by line with [18, 33]). The asymptotic Bethe equations are $p_j L + \sum_l \Theta(p_j - p_l) = 2\pi\hbar I_j$ with $\Theta(D) = 2\hbar\,\mathrm{Im}\log\Gamma(1 + iD/\hbar) + 2D\log\hbar$, whose classical limit is $2(D\log|D| - D)$; the method is that of Sutherland and Mertens **(b)** [34, 29].

Proposition 4.4 ([bad], **(c)**). *As $\hbar \to 0$:*

1. *the ground-state quasi-momenta fill $[-2b, 2b]$ with the arcsine density of total weight $1/a$, which is the Lax spectrum of the static lattice, and reproduce the ground-state energy per particle b^2;*

2. *a particle excitation at $p = 2sb\cosh\kappa$, the soliton's Lax eigenvalue, has dressed momentum P_n/a and dressed energy, relative to the edge, equal to the soliton energy E;*

[27] Verification: `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (check 4, three parameter points, 10^{-16}); `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (check 8, closed form).

[28] Verification: `phase1/scripts/toda_limit.py`.

[29] Verification: `phase2/scripts/toda_soliton_classical.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py`.

[30] Verification: `phase1/scripts/toda_limit.py` (exact two-soliton in the lattice, 10^{-17}); `phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py`.

3. *the exact classical physical-frame shifts are* $\Delta x_1 = a\Delta n_1 + M_2$ *and* $\Delta x_2 = a\Delta n_2 - M_1$*, the extra terms being the displacement caused by the other soliton's compression; they are given by* $\Delta x_2 = -\partial\Phi(1|2)/\partial P_2$ *and* $\Delta x_1 = +\partial\Phi(2|1)/\partial P_1$*, where* $\Phi(1|2)$ *is the dressed Bethe phase of excitation 1 in the presence of 2;*

4. $\Phi(1|2) + \Phi(2|1)$ *is not separable; its mixed derivative equals exactly* $M_1'(P_{n2}'/a - \Pi_2') + M_2'(P_{n1}'/a - \Pi_1')$*, i.e. the Bethe ansatz carries precisely the cross terms of Proposition 3.1.*

[31]

Proposition 4.5 ([bad], **(c)**). *In the Toda label frame, two-soliton scattering satisfies* $\sum_j dP_{n,j} \wedge d\Delta n_j = d\Pi_2 \wedge dM_1 - d\Pi_1 \wedge dM_2$ *(30 digits), the analogue of* (18)*. The Darboux phase is*

$$\delta_T = (p_1 - p_2)\log A_T + M_1 M_2(v_1 - v_2) = (p_1 - p_2)\log A_T - (\Pi_1 M_2 - \Pi_2 M_1), \tag{24}$$

with $p = 2sb\cosh\kappa$ *and* v *the label velocity.*[32]

Proposition 4.6 ([bad], **(c)**). *With* $\kappa_j = \sqrt{3}\beta_j \to 0$ *and action scale* $S_{\mathrm{Toda}} = 3b\, S_{\mathrm{Bouss}}$*,*

$$\delta_T/(3b\,\delta_{\mathrm{bad}}) \to 1$$

for overtaking and *head-on collisions; the error is* $\approx 6 \times 10^{-6}$ *at* $\beta \sim 3 \times 10^{-3}$*.*[33]

In head-on collisions the leading Boussinesq phase $4\beta_1\beta_2$ is dominated by the topological term ($\frac{16}{3}\beta_1\beta_2$ against $-\frac{4}{3}\beta_1\beta_2$). Agreement in that channel therefore confirms the topological term of (21) from an exactly solvable quantum model **(c)**. The split between the two terms of (24) is not preserved by the scaling limit; only their sum is **(c)**.

Limitation. The Toda continuum limit produces the bad equation only at leading order in amplitude, so Toda tests (21) only as $\beta \to 0$. Finite-β solitons have widths comparable to the dispersion length, where the bad equation is ill-posed and Toda and Boussinesq differ at $O(1)$ **(c)**. An exact S-matrix for finite-amplitude bad solitons would require a quantum regularisation that agrees with Boussinesq at the dispersion scale; we know of none **(d)**. The $O(\hbar)$ Toda corrections and the Fermi-edge double-scaling limit are discussed in Section 8.

5 Integrable defects at tree level

[good] Throughout this section the bulk theory is the good equation.

5.1 Corrigan–Zambon defects

Corrigan and Zambon construct integrable type-I defects for the good Boussinesq equation, with a defect Lagrangian $D = u_t F + v_t G + H$ at x_0 coupling the fields u ($x < x_0$) and v ($x > x_0$) **(a)** [12]. Within their ansatz, with the nonlinear term present, the defect coefficients are forced to be imaginary when the dispersion has the bad sign, so *no real type-I defect of this family exists for the bad equation*; for the linear equation real defects do exist **(c)**.[34] A type-II defect for the bad equation is not excluded **(d)**. This is why defects are a good-equation topic.

[31] Verification: `phase2/scripts/toda_bethe_classical.py` (10^{-8}, Chebyshev method); `phase2/scripts/toda_dressed_phase_check.py`; `phase2/scripts/toda_ba_vs_label.py`.

[32] Verification: `phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py` (symplectic identity); `phase2/scripts/toda_scaling_fast.py` (remainder fitted to $M_1M_2(v_1 - v_2)$, ratio 1 to ten digits); `phase2/scripts/toda_ba_vs_label.py` ($\Phi(1|2) = \delta_T + M_1(P_{n2}/a - \Pi_2) + f(\kappa_1)$ and its mirror, to machine precision).

[33] Verification: `phase2/scripts/toda_scaling_fast.py`.

[34] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_check.py` (sewing conditions and momentum flux rederived from the action with the dispersion sign kept symbolic).

Dictionary. With $c = \lambda = \kappa = 1$ in [12], $u_{\mathrm{CZ}} = -3\phi$, $L_{\mathrm{CZ}} = 9\mathcal{L}$, $P_{\mathrm{CZ}} = 9P$, $\gamma = \operatorname{sech}\theta = k$ and $\nu = \tanh\theta = \epsilon\cos\alpha$ **(c)**.[35] The defect has parameter $s = \sigma_0$ and orientation $\eta = \pm 1$ (CZ's $\alpha_{\mathrm{CZ}} = \eta/\sqrt{3}$). The sewing conditions were rederived from the action and checked on the exact solutions **(c)**.[36] One- and two-soliton solutions are purely transmitted, each e^{θ_j} being multiplied by

$$z = \frac{\sinh\theta + s\cosh\theta - \eta\sqrt{3}}{\sinh\theta + s\cosh\theta + \eta\sqrt{3}} \tag{25}$$

on the far side **(a)** [12, (5.5),(5.11)].

Proposition 5.1 ([good], **(c)**). *With the soliton roots* (10) *and the* defect root $q = -s/(2\sqrt{3})$,

$$z = \left(\frac{p_b - q}{p_a - q}\right)^{\eta}, \qquad \ell(q) = \tfrac{1}{2}(3s - s^3). \tag{26}$$

Formally $z^{-\eta}$ is the cross-ratio (15) *of the soliton with the pair (q, ∞): the defect behaves like half a soliton. The transmitted solution is regular iff $z > 0$, i.e. $q \notin [p_b, p_a]$; for $|s| > 2$ every soliton is regular, in agreement with [12]* **(a)**. *The delay is $\Delta x = -k^{-1}\log z^{\epsilon}$.*[37]

Corrigan and Zambon remark that no factor of the two-soliton constant seems closely related to z **(a)**; in root variables the relation is transparent.

5.2 Symplectic structure with a defect

The defect adds $F\,\delta u + G\,\delta v$ at x_0 to the canonical one-form. Asymptotically $F \to f(u,v)$ and $G \to g(u,v)$, so the defect contributes $\Omega_D = (f_v - g_u)\,du \wedge dv|_{x_0}$. On every vacuum sector $u - v$ at x_0 is a discrete label, so $du = dv$ and $\Omega_D = 0$ **(c)**.[38] Hence the type-I defect has no continuous degree of freedom and there are no soliton–defect cross terms.[39] For one soliton, any map $X \mapsto X + \Delta x(P)$ is then symplectic, so the content lies in the phase and in the multi-soliton case.

5.3 The transmission phase

Proposition 5.2 ([good], **(c)**). *With $\Delta x = -\partial\delta_D/\partial P$, for all $\epsilon, \eta = \pm 1$ and all s in the regular region,*

$$\boxed{\delta_D = \tfrac{2}{9}\big(\ell - \ell_D\big)\log z^{\epsilon} - \tfrac{2}{3}\big(\Pi M_D - \Pi_D M\big)}, \qquad \ell_D = \ell(q), \quad M_D = \epsilon\eta\, q, \quad \Pi_D = \epsilon\eta\,\frac{s^2 - 2}{2\sqrt{3}}, \tag{27}$$

up to an additive s-dependent constant that the classical data do not fix. The two orientations are semiclassically inverse: $\delta_D(-\eta) = -\delta_D(\eta)$.[40]

The defect enters exactly like a second particle with spectral parameter $\ell(q)$ and charges (M_D, Π_D) **(c)** (formula); the particle reading is **(d)**. In CZ's notation $\ell_D = -\sqrt{3}\,\eta\rho_0$, so the defect's spectral parameter is its constant ρ_0 **(c)**. Since M_D and Π_D depend on ϵ, they are effective coefficients of a mutual-statistics term rather than intrinsic defect charges.

[35] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (check 1).

[36] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/verify_defect_solutions.py` (10^{-28}–10^{-31} away from poles).

[37] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (checks 2–3; delay from peak positions, 16 cases, 10^{-39}).

[38] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (check 6).

[39] We use the shift-invariant gauge $f = g = -\sigma^2/(4\mu)$ with $f_v - g_u = \sigma$, in which the total Π is conserved through the defect. The example gauge printed in [12, (3.43),(3.47)] gives 2σ; this looks like a typo there **(c)** (`corrigan-zambon/README.md`).

[40] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (check 4, 40 digits).

5.4 Two solitons and a defect

Proposition 5.3 ([good], **(c)**). *For two solitons crossing a defect (overtaking and head-on, both orientations, s of both signs, regular region):*

1. *the position shifts are $\Delta x_j = \Delta x_j^{\mathrm{ss}} + \Delta x_j^{D}$, identical whether the soliton–soliton collision happens left or right of the defect;*
2. *the identity (18) holds with the soliton–soliton cross terms and no defect cross terms;*
3. *in the Darboux frame (19), $\Delta x'_j = -\partial_{P_j}(\delta_{12} + \delta_{1D} + \delta_{2D})$.*

[41]

Semiclassically the soliton–soliton–defect amplitude therefore factorises as $S_{12}T_1T_2$, and the compatibility relation $T_1T_2S_{12} = S_{12}T_2T_1$ is automatic for diagonal, purely transmitting scattering. The nontrivial content is that the defect shifts do not depend on the other soliton, and that the Darboux corrections are unaffected by the defect because $\Omega_D = 0$ **(c)**.

5.5 Vacua, absorption and linear stability

The static defect vacua are $\sigma \in \{s, \sigma_+, \sigma_-\}$ with $\sigma_\pm^2 + s\sigma_\pm + s^2 = 3$. Writing $\sigma = -2\sqrt{3}\,q'$, this reads $q'^2 + qq' + q^2 = \frac{1}{4}$: the excited vacua are the *other two roots of the KP triple containing* q **(c)**. Absorption ($z \in \{0, \infty\}$) occurs iff $q = p_a$ or $q = p_b$ **(a)** [12]/**(c)**. The defect with root q then absorbs the soliton (q, p) and becomes the defect with root p in the same triple, with exact energy–momentum balance between the soliton and the jump of the defect's (E_D, P_D) **(c)**.[42] On an absorption line $\ell = \ell(q)$, so δ_D stays finite while the delay diverges logarithmically **(c)**.[43]

Proposition 5.4 ([good], **(c)**). *Linearise the sewing conditions about a static vacuum σ_{vac}; the bulk equation becomes $a_{tt} = a_{xx} - a_{xxxx}$.*

1. *On every real vacuum phonons are purely transmitted, $R = 0$, $|T| = 1$, with T equal to CZ's linear-defect formula [12, (4.6)] at $\sigma_0 \to \sigma_{\mathrm{vac}}$.*
2. *A vacuum has a localised growing mode iff $\eta\,\sigma_{\mathrm{vac}} > -1$. Every growing mode found has zero conserved energy; the defect's quadratic energy is indefinite.*
3. *The three vacua of a defect are $\sigma = -2\sqrt{3}\,q'$ for the three roots q' of one KP triple, and exactly one root has $\eta q' > 1/(2\sqrt{3})$. Hence* exactly one vacuum per triple is linearly stable.

[44]

Consequently a defect with ground vacuum $\sigma = s$ is linearly stable iff $\eta s < -1$. Corrigan and Zambon's illustrative example ($s = 0.5$, $\eta = +1$) has a linearly unstable ground vacuum, with growth rate ≈ 0.4999; its exact soliton solutions are unaffected **(c)**. For a stable ground defect both excited vacua are unstable, absorption is possible only for $-2 < \eta s < -1$, and the absorbed soliton leaves the defect in an unstable state, presumably a resonance that re-emits **(d)**.

[41] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (checks 2–4; shifts from peak positions at $t = \pm 1000$ to 10^{-27}; identities to 10^{-40}).

[42] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (check 5, 10^{-40}).

[43] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (check 5).

[44] Verification: `corrigan-zambon/defect_vacuum_stability.py`. The root search is a fine scan of the imaginary axis plus Newton iteration from a complex grid; it is numerical, not a proof of completeness.

5.6 Tree-level fusion

Proposition 5.5 ([good], **(c)**). *Let a defect with root q absorb the soliton $S = \{q, q'\}$ and become the defect with root q'. For every test soliton 3 in the regular region,*

$$\delta_D^{(q')}(3) - \delta_D^{(q)}(3) = \rho\,\big[\delta(3,S) + M_S\Pi_3\big], \qquad \rho = \pm 1, \tag{28}$$

with no free constant: the constants left open in Proposition 5.2 are consistent with zero. The term $M_S\Pi_3$ is the cross term of soliton 3 with the ϕ-jump M_S stored in the excited defect.[45]

Identity (28) is a classical, leading-order soliton–soliton–defect bootstrap **(c)**. All three solitons of one KP triple have the same ℓ. Promoting (28) to an exact relation between quantum amplitudes would require the excited defect vacua to be asymptotic states. Proposition 5.4 shows that they are linearly unstable, so any quantum fusion argument built on (28) is heuristic **(d)**. Quantum fusion would also need the boundary renormalisation and localised charges of the defect, which are not available (Section 7).

5.7 What is not covered

For ordinary one- and two-soliton solutions the defect is purely transmitting **(a)** [12], so $R = 0$ at the order considered here **(c)**. Corrigan and Zambon's reflection occurs only for merging/splitting three-exponential solutions, and their defect can decay into two solitons **(a)** [12]. These processes change the soliton number and lie outside the fixed-number phase-space description used here; we have not derived a reflection amplitude. A guess is that semiclassical reflection is a resonance phenomenon, absorption into an excited vacuum followed by emission into another chord of the triple **(d)**.

6 Structural results on quantum inverse scattering and affine Toda

6.1 Non-ultralocality

A Faddeev–Korepin–Sklyanin lattice quantisation would need an ultralocal r-matrix Poisson algebra for the Lax connection.

Proposition 6.1 ([good], **(c)**). *In canonical variables the Lax data of Section 2 are $q_L = \frac{3}{2}\phi_x - \frac{1}{4}$ and $r_L = \frac{1}{2}q_{L,x} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}\pi$ (good real form; the bad one differs by factors of i). Their brackets are*

$$\{q_L(x), r_L(y)\} = \tfrac{3\sqrt{3}}{8}\,\delta'(x-y), \qquad \{q_L, q_L\} = \{r_L, r_L\} = 0,$$

so the companion-matrix Lax connection is non-ultralocal.[46]

Two ways out are known in general, and neither yet gives a theory on the line. Maillet's r/s formalism with lattice regularisation [27] has not been constructed for Boussinesq. The Miura (free-field) route of Bazhanov, Hibberd and Khoroshkin [3] and Hikami [19] yields $U_q(\widehat{\mathfrak{sl}}_3)$ T- and Q-operators, but in the chiral setting on a circle, with no particle sector **(a)**. Since scattering is diagonal, the Yang–Baxter equation is automatic **(c)**; the "beyond Yang–Baxter" phenomena of [15] concern polarisations of the matrix equation and are vacuous for the scalar one **(c)**.

[45] Verification: `phase2/scripts/defect_smatrix_good_continuation.py` (check 4; 12 triangles, 10^{-40}).
[46] Verification: `phase2/scripts/routes_BC_checks.py` (check B).

6.2 $\mathfrak{sl}_3$ factorisation of the interaction constant

Proposition 6.2 ([good & bad], **(c)**). *Let* $A^{(12)}(\theta) = \dfrac{2\cosh\theta + 1}{2(1+\cosh\theta)}$ *be Hollowood's* $a_2^{(1)}$ *affine Toda interaction constant between the two fundamental species* **(a)** *[22, (1.19)]. For the bad equation, with* $S = \beta_1 + \beta_2$, $D = \beta_1 - \beta_2$,

$$A_{\rm ov} = \frac{A^{(12)}(S)}{A^{(12)}(D)} \cdot \frac{\tanh^2(D/2)}{\tanh^2(S/2)}, \qquad A_{\rm ho}(\beta_1,\beta_2) = \frac{1}{A_{\rm ov}(\beta_1,\beta_2+i\pi)}, \tag{29}$$

where $\tanh^2(\theta/2)$ *is the sine-Gordon two-soliton factor. Equivalently* $A_{\rm ov} = G(S/2)/G(D/2)$ *with*

$$G(y) = \frac{16\prod_{a=1,2}\sinh\frac{y+ia\pi/3}{2}\,\sinh\frac{y-ia\pi/3}{2}}{\sinh^2 y}.$$

For the good equation the corresponding form is

$$A_{\rm ov} = \frac{\sin(\frac{S}{2}+\frac{\pi}{3})\sin(\frac{S}{2}-\frac{\pi}{3})\,\sin^2\frac{D}{2}}{\sin(\frac{D}{2}+\frac{\pi}{3})\sin(\frac{D}{2}-\frac{\pi}{3})\,\sin^2\frac{S}{2}}.$$

[47]

The Boussinesq interaction is thus built from exactly the $\mathfrak{sl}_3$ blocks, but in the form $F(\beta_1-\beta_2)/F(\beta_1+\beta_2)$, the structure of scattering off a particle and its mirror image. This suggests a link with boundary (reflection) amplitudes and with the boundary affine Toda structure in [3] **(d)**.

6.3 Obstructions

- [bad] The semiclassical phase is not of product form: $\partial_S\partial_D\delta \neq 0$ (for example -0.55 at $(S,D) = (1.4, 0.6)$). Hence no S-matrix of the form $F(\beta_1-\beta_2)G(\beta_1+\beta_2)$, including pure $\mathfrak{sl}_3$ mirror forms and quantum dilogarithms of $\beta_1 \pm \beta_2$ separately, has the semiclassical limit $e^{i\delta/\hbar}$ **(c)**.[48] The weight $\frac{2}{9}(\ell_1-\ell_2)$ of $\log A_{12}$ is not a sum of functions of S and D, and T_{12} has no affine Toda analogue.

- In the affine Toda constant the mass term $4m^2\sin^2(\pi a/3)$ appears where Boussinesq has K^4, so the species label is replaced by the wavenumber; no limit of fixed-species Toda solitons yields Boussinesq solitons **(c)**.

- Soliton–breather scattering in $a_2^{(1)}$ Toda is flawed both classically and quantum mechanically **(b)** [35].

The structural similarity with affine Toda is therefore precise, but we have no dictionary that transfers its S-matrices.

[47] Verification: `phase2/scripts/routes_BC_checks.py` (check C, bad); `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py` (good).
[48] Verification: `phase2/scripts/smatrix_rejected_forms.py`.

7 One-loop corrections

Pending

This section is pending the projected fluctuation determinant package and resolution of the open one-loop audits (`phase2/report.pdf`); no one-loop S-matrix is claimed here.

Phonon scattering on soliton and defect backgrounds. Linearising the τ-function of the good equation produces reflectionless phonon modes on N-soliton and Corrigan–Zambon defect backgrounds with factorised transmission amplitudes **(c)** (`phase2/oneloop_phase.pdf`, `phase2/oneloop_defect_phase.pdf`); for the bad equation, the one-loop mode sum is well posed only on the Charlier–Lenells stable subspace $|q| < 1$ **(c)** (`phase2/oneloop.pdf`). For the defect sewing determinant, independent checks correct a missing factor of 16 in the prefactor and an admissible-root branch change in the growing-mode pair **(c)** (`phase2/audit_frames_defects.pdf`).

Continuum integrals, charges and the projected determinant. The Faddeev–Korepin continuum integrals evaluate in closed form in terms of the Legendre function χ_2 and logarithms, and direct potential-field quadrature confirms the one-soliton spectral-density identity **(c)** (`phase2/audit_determinant_foundations.pdf`); the regulated co-moving mode sum reproduces the proposed one-loop charge Lagrangian when its cutoff endpoint is retained **(c)** (conditional, `phase2/audit_charges_action.pdf`); and potential-tail cross terms cancel from the finite collective symplectic density **(c)**, although the explicit projector does not preserve fixed potential endpoints **(c)** (`phase2/audit_projected_measure.pdf`). However, raw phase integrals are not exchange-antisymmetric and carry orientation-dependent discrepancies **(c)** (`phase2/independent_phase2h_audit.pdf`), and the full boundary-compatible fluctuation determinant, collective measure, defect UV counterterm and absolute phase normalisation remain unestablished **(d)**.

8 The quantum Toda Fermi-edge limit

Pending

This section is pending the audit of the Phase 2i Wiener–Hopf analysis (`phase2/toda_wh_and_kp_synthesis.pdf`) and the derivation of a common quantum momentum and frame dictionary (`phase2/report.pdf`). No Phase 2i claim is included in this draft.

Double-scaling limit and frame dictionary. In the Fermi-edge double-scaling limit $\beta \to 0$, $\hbar \propto \beta^2$ of the quantum Toda Bethe ansatz (where excitations lie within $O(\hbar)$ of the Fermi edge and $\delta/\hbar = O(1)$), the dressed two-particle phase probes small-amplitude quantum scattering of bad Boussinesq solitons, extending Pustilnik and Matveev's KdV analysis [30] to bidirectional collisions **(d)**. Within the implemented classical frame conversion, finite-$\hbar$ numerical data (`phase2/toda_route.pdf`, `phase2/toda_edge.pdf`, `phase2/matching.pdf`) approach the classical phase in the head-on channel and deviate from the Gamma candidate of Section 9 near threshold in the overtaking channel **(c)**. Independent Fredholm identities fix the dressed edge momentum $P_{\mathrm{dr}}(q) = \pi\hbar_T/a$ and an endpoint reciprocity bilinear for the symmetric dressed phase, revealing a nonseparable finite-$\hbar_T$ remainder after the classical frame subtraction **(c)** (`phase2/audit_toda_dictionary.pdf`); the physical quantum frame dictionary and its continuum matching at fixed quantum observables remain open **(d)**.

9 Exact S-matrix candidates and constraints

Pending

This section is pending the $O(\hbar^0)$ input from Sections 7 and 8, which is needed to decide between candidate amplitudes and fix $O(\hbar^0)$ ambiguities.

Requirements, exclusions and candidates. Without boost symmetry, a diagonal two-soliton S-matrix $S(P_1, P_2)$ must satisfy unitarity, the semiclassical limit $S \simeq e^{i\delta/\hbar}$ including the topological phase T_{12}, the crossing-type relation of Proposition 4.2, real analyticity and, for the bad equation, bound-state poles at the Bogdan–Charkina strings (23) (Yang–Baxter is automatic for diagonal scattering **(c)**). Stirling asymptotics force any Gamma factor to depend on the uniform weight $\eta = \frac{2}{9}(\ell_1 - \ell_2)/\hbar$, excluding at leading order both product forms $F(\beta_1 - \beta_2)G(\beta_1 + \beta_2)$ (Section 6) and Gamma functions of individual root differences **(c)** (`phase2/scripts/smatrix_rejected_forms.py`). For the bad equation, the candidate $S_{\mathrm{ov}} = \frac{\Gamma(1+i\eta)}{\Gamma(1-i\eta)}(e^2 A_{12}/\eta^2)^{i\eta} e^{iT_{12}/\hbar}$ and $S_{\mathrm{ho}} = \frac{\Gamma(1-i\eta)}{\Gamma(1+i\eta)}(A_{12}\eta^2/e^2)^{i\eta} e^{iT_{12}/\hbar}$ **(d)** satisfies unitarity, crossing, the semiclassical limit up to $\pm\pi/2$, and has simple poles on the physical sheet at the Bogdan–Charkina levels $I_{\mathrm{br}} = N\hbar$ $(N \geq 1)$ **(c)** (`phase2/smatrix_ansatz.pdf`); CDD factors, $\hbar$ renormalisation, Maslov constants and the relationship to the good-equation amplitude remain open **(d)**.

10 Open problems

Pending

Draft, based on the ranked next steps of the master report; to be revised when Sections 7–9 are written. The ranking is a research judgement **(d)**.

1. **A common quantum momentum and frame dictionary.** Relate the dressed Toda momentum, the quantum edge reference, the collective soliton charges and the frame contribution at fixed physical observables, with the endpoint reciprocity identity of the Toda dictionary audit as a check. The direct Toda expansion can proceed independently, keeping logarithmic terms and separating numerical errors.

2. **The projected one-loop determinant.** Starting from the factorised collective symplectic density, specify the spatial domain and admissible endpoint variations, and derive the field and constraint measures, the projection, the time-boundary determinant, continuum completeness and the absolute phase normalisation together.

3. **Quantum defects.** Before any quantum fusion argument, derive the defect's localised charges and boundary renormalisation; keep the admissible spectral branches; distinguish stable external defect states (one per KP triple) from unstable intermediate ones.

4. **Uniformity of the Toda expansion.** Check logarithmic remainders, nearly equal amplitudes and the limit of a vanishing smaller soliton, and establish which limits commute before identifying expansion coefficients with continuum loop orders.

5. **All-loop kernels and ring quantisation.** An asymptotic Bethe ansatz on a ring, $P_j\Lambda + \sum_{k\neq j}\delta(j,k) = 2\pi\hbar n_j$, is natural **(d)**, but the twisted boundary conditions forced by the ϕ-winding M have not been worked out. Quantum-dilogarithm kernels remain a possibility, to be constrained only by established input. Non-ultralocal quantum inverse scattering (Proposition 6.1) is a separate, longer-term route.

Further open questions raised by the classical analysis:

- *Number-changing processes.* Whether the Y-junctions, virtual solitons and resonance lines of the good equation produce inelastic quantum channels **(b)** [12], or appear only as threshold or bound-state singularities of the elastic amplitude **(d)**.

- *The cusp.* A uniform semiclassical treatment near $\alpha = \pi/3$, where $dP/d\alpha = 0$, the one-soliton symplectic form degenerates and the overtaking resonance line passes through $\alpha_1 = \alpha_2 = \pi/3$ **(d)**.
- *Bound states of the good equation.* The good equation has no regular Hirota breathers, so the existence of quantum bound states is open.
- *Finite-amplitude bad solitons.* No integrable lattice is known that agrees with Boussinesq at the dispersion scale **(d)**.
- *Defect reflection and decay.* Reflection and two-soliton decay at Corrigan–Zambon defects, and type-II defects for the bad equation **(d)**.
- *Universality of the phase structure.* Test whether $\delta = (\text{difference of spectral parameters}) \times \log A - c\,(\Pi_1 M_2 - \Pi_2 M_1)$ holds for KdV and other models with a continuous kink charge **(d)**.

A Claims and verification

All scripts are in the project repository and end by printing `ALL CHECKS PASSED`. Paths are relative to the repository root. The script written for this paper is `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py`; it checks the formulas stated here in a form not verified verbatim elsewhere.

Claim	Eq.	Lab.	Verification
Sign conventions; Lagrangians (3)	both	**(c)**	`phase0/checks/convention_check.py`, `phase1/scripts/charges.py`, `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (1–2)
Real/imaginary Lax time	both	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/lax_zero_curvature.py`
Charges (8), $dE/dP = v$, (9)	both	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/charges.py`, `phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py`, `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (3, 9)
Bounded P, cusp, heavy branch, degenerate $\Omega\|_{\text{sol}}$ (Prop. 2.1)	good	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/charges.py`
KP roots, $\ell(p)$, $\lambda = -\ell/(12\sqrt{3})$; H_n on solitons	both	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (2), `phase2/scripts/smatrix_ansatz.py`, `phase1/scripts/charges.py`, `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (4)
N-soliton Hirota condition, $N \le 4$	good	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/hirota_solitons.py`
Closed forms of A_{12}; cross-ratio (Prop. 2.2)	both	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`, `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (5), `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (1), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (4)
Regimes and resonances (Prop. 2.3); shifts (16)	good	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`
Breathers (Prop. 2.4)	both	**(c)**	`phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`, `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (4)

Claim	Eq.	Lab.	Verification
Continuation $\alpha = i\beta$ (Remark 2.5)	both	**(c)**	`paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (5)
Cross terms; symplectic scattering (Props. 3.1–3.2)	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/symplectic_scattering.py` (bad), `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (1, both), `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (3, good)
Darboux shifts; γ	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (1), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (9)
Semiclassical phase (21)	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py`, `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (1)
Unitarity, crossing-type relation	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (2–3), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (6)
Resonance lines, cusp (Prop. 4.2)	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (5)
Small-amplitude limits	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (6), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (7)
Breather action and strings (Prop. 4.3)	bad	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` (4), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (8)
Toda solitons, label momentum, A_T	bad	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/toda_soliton_classical.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py`, `phase1/scripts/toda_limit.py`
Toda two-body R	bad	**(c)**	standard; used in `phase2/scripts/toda_bethe_quantum.py`, not separately checked
Classical Bethe-ansatz limit (Prop. 4.4)	bad	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/toda_bethe_classical.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_dressed_phase_check.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_ba_vs_label.py`
Toda label-frame phase; scaling (Props. 4.5–4.6)	bad	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_scaling_fast.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_ba_vs_label.py`
No real type-I defect for the bad equation	bad	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_check.py`
CZ dictionary; sewing conditions	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (1), `corrigan-zambon/verify_defect_solutions.py`
Root form of z; delay (Prop. 5.1)	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (2–3), `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py` (10)
$\Omega_D = 0$ on vacua	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (6)
Transmission phase (27)	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (4)
Two solitons and a defect (Prop. 5.3)	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py` (2–4)
Vacua $\leftrightarrow$ KP triple; absorption balance	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` (5)

Claim	Eq.	Lab.	Verification
Linear stability (Prop. 5.4)	good	**(c)**	`corrigan-zambon/defect_vacuum_stability.py`
Tree-level fusion (28)	good	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/defect_smatrix_good_continuation.py` (4)
Non-ultralocality (Prop. 6.1)	good	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/routes_BC_checks.py` (B)
$\mathfrak{sl}_3$ factorisation (Prop. 6.2)	both	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/routes_BC_checks.py` (C), `phase1/scripts/interaction_regimes.py`
No product-form S-matrix	bad	**(c)**	`phase2/scripts/smatrix_rejected_forms.py`
Interpretations (mutual statistics, universality, strings as poles, defect resonances, cusp uniformisation)	—	**(d)**	—

Runs for this draft. On 4 November 2026 the following were rerun and ended with `ALL CHECKS PASSED`: `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py`, `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py`, `phase2/scripts/symplectic_scattering.py`, `phase2/scripts/semiclassical_phase.py`, `phase2/scripts/routes_BC_checks.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_label_symplectic.py`, `phase2/scripts/toda_scaling_fast.py`, `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py`, `corrigan-zambon/defect_two_soliton_symplectic.py`, `corrigan-zambon/defect_vacuum_stability.py`. The other scripts were not rerun for this draft; their results are taken from the write-ups that cite them.

Failures recorded.

1. In `paper/scripts/paper_conventions_check.py`, the good-equation crossing check first used the head-on point $(\alpha_1, \alpha_2) = (0.9, 0.15)$, which lies in the singular region $A_{\text{ho}} < 0$. There the identity holds only modulo the branch of the logarithm (residual 5×10^{-3} in the imaginary part). The point was replaced by $(1.3, 0.2)$ in the regular region, and the statement in Proposition 4.2 is restricted to the regular head-on region accordingly.

2. `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` prints, but does not assert, the bad-equation crossing relation; it is now asserted in the paper script (check 6). Failures recorded in earlier phases are listed in the respective write-ups (`phase1/review.pdf`, `phase2/report.pdf`, `phase2/defect_semiclassics.pdf`).

B Inconsistencies found

The following inconsistencies between project write-ups (or between a write-up and its scripts) were found while preparing this draft. None was silently resolved; the choice made in this paper is stated.

1. **Sign of the cubic term in the bad Lagrangian.** `phase2/report.tex` (§1) gives $\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}\phi_t^2 - \frac{1}{2}\phi_x^2 + \frac{1}{2}\phi_{xx}^2 + \phi_x^3$ for $v_{tt} = v_{xx} + v_{xxxx} + 3(v^2)_{xx}$. Its Euler–Lagrange equation is $v_{tt} = v_{xx} + v_{xxxx} - 3(v^2)_{xx}$, which the positive soliton does not solve. The bad equation with positive solitons, and the energy $E = \frac{2}{15}k^3(5+4k^2)$ quoted in the same report, require $-\phi_x^3$. This paper uses $-\phi_x^3$ (paper script, checks 1–3). The charges M, Π, P quoted in the report do not depend on this sign.

2. **Classical soliton energy in the one-loop write-up.** `phase2/oneloop_phase.tex`, eq. (onesol_data), gives $E = \frac{1}{3}k^3(2\cos^2\alpha + 1)$ for the good soliton and states $dE/d\alpha = v\,dP/d\alpha$. Direct quadrature gives $E = \frac{2}{15}k^3(5 - 4k^2)$ (as in `phase1/review.tex`), and the printed formula violates $dE/d\alpha = v\,dP/d\alpha$ (paper script, check 3). A search of the `oneloop_good_*` scripts found no use of the printed formula. This paper uses the Phase 1 value.

3. **Defect root convention.** `phase2/defect_semiclassics.tex` and `corrigan-zambon/defect_transmission_phase.py` use $s = \sigma_0$, $q = -s/(2\sqrt{3})$, CZ's $\alpha_{\mathrm{CZ}} = \eta/\sqrt{3}$, and $z = ((p_b - q)/(p_a - q))^\eta$; stability is $\eta\sigma < -1$, i.e. $\eta q > 1/(2\sqrt{3})$. `phase2/oneloop_defect_phase.tex` and `phase2/report.tex` define $s = \eta\sigma$ and $q_D = -\eta\sigma/(2\sqrt{3})$ (with $\alpha_{\mathrm{CZ}} = 1/(2\sqrt{3})$, $\beta_{\mathrm{CZ}} = \eta/(2\sqrt{3})$), and state stability as $q_D > 1/(2\sqrt{3})$. The two agree for $\eta = +1$; for $\eta = -1$ they assign opposite roots to the same σ unless the orientation conventions for CZ's parameters also differ, which we could not check (the CZ full text is not in the local `literature/` folder). This paper uses the Phase 2c convention, which is the one verified symbolically against CZ's formula for z, and states stability as $\eta\sigma < -1$, which both write-ups share.

4. **Transmission factor in the one-loop defect write-up.** In `phase2/oneloop_defect_phase.tex`, eq. (z1_sol), the middle expression $\big((k_1 - v_1/\sqrt{3} - s/\sqrt{3})/(k_1 + v_1/\sqrt{3} + s/\sqrt{3})\big)^{-\eta}$ equals $-1/z$, not the root form $z = ((p_b - q_D)/(p_a - q_D))^\eta$ given on the right of the same equation (paper script, check 10). The root form agrees with Phase 2c. This looks like a typo; whether it propagated into that write-up's scripts was not checked.

5. **Wording of the KdV-limit remark.** `phase2/report.tex` (Remark after Prop. 2.3) says that the topological term and the KdV-type term $2\beta_1 \log A$ have ratio tending to 0.564. The number printed by `phase2/scripts/consistency_checks.py` is the ratio of the full $\partial\delta/\partial\beta_1$ to $2\beta_1 \log A$, which tends to $1 + 2\beta_2/(\beta_1 \log A_{\mathrm{KdV}})$; the cross-term part of the Darboux shift contributes $4\beta_2$ (paper script, check 7). The qualitative statement (same order) is correct. This paper states the ratio precisely.

6. **Script names in the master report.** The appendix of `phase2/report.tex` cites `smatrix_boot.py` and `toda_quantum_correction.py`; the files are `smatrix_poles_bootstrap.py` and `toda_quantum_corrections.py`. `smatrix_semiclassical_unitarity_crossing.py` and `smatrix_rejected_forms.py` are not listed there.

7. **Root variables (notation only).** Phase 1 uses μ with $\mu_1 + \mu_2 = -v/\sqrt{3}$; Phase 2c uses p with $p_a + p_b = +v/\sqrt{3}$; they are related by $\mu = -p$, and the Lax eigenvalue is $\lambda = -\ell/(12\sqrt{3})$ (paper script, check 4). `phase2/smatrix_ansatz.tex` uses yet another μ (complex roots of $\mu^3 + \mu/4 = i\ell/(12\sqrt{3})$) for the bad equation. No error, but the three conventions are easy to confuse.

8. **Toda wavenumber (notation only).** In `phase1/review.tex` and `phase1/scripts/toda_limit.py`, κ is the Hirota exponent ($\tau = 1 + e^{\kappa n - \omega t}$) and the small-amplitude map is $\kappa = \sqrt{12}\,k$. In `phase2/toda_route.tex`, κ is half of that (the $\mathrm{sech}^2(\kappa n - \dots)$ argument) and the map is $\kappa = \sqrt{3}\beta$. The two are consistent; this paper uses the Phase 2b normalisation.

9. **Phase numbering (minor).** `phase2/oneloop_defect_phase.tex` refers to `defect_semiclassics.pdf` as Phase 2d; `README.md` and the write-up itself call it Phase 2c.

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Reading status is as recorded in `phase0/literature_map.md` and the bibliography of `phase1/review.tex`; "read" refers to project agents in earlier phases. No reference was added for this draft that does not already appear in the project's write-ups.